



GRADUATE DIPLOMA IN MANAGEMENT

August 2025

GDM 602 – Human Resource Management

(Batch 84)

Case Study (Pre-seen)

Qualification	ATHE Level 6 Graduate Diploma in Management
Issued Date	9 August 2025
Module Tutor	Sharuga Rajeswara <i>MBA</i>
Exam Date & Time	16 August 2025 - 2.00 p.m. – 5.10 p.m.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this unit students will be able to:

- LO1:** Understand the scope, functions and processes of Human Resource Management in improving organisational and employee performance
- LO2:** Understand the effective Human Resource Management practices in a work-related context to improve sustainable performance

Building Resilient Workforces Through Sustainable HRM Practices

John Keells Holdings PLC (JKH), Sri Lanka's largest listed conglomerate, operates across leisure, retail, consumer foods, property, and financial services. Recruitment at JKH combines external hiring with an internal job posting system to encourage career mobility, supported by flagship programmes like the John Keells Management Trainee and FastTrack Internship. The Group's "ONE JKH" Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DE&I) initiative integrates sustainability into recruitment by actively promoting gender parity, creating opportunities for Persons With Disabilities (PWD) and implementing gender-neutral recruitment language. However, a key challenge in recruitment is the difficulty in finding candidates with the right technical expertise and leadership skills, particularly for digital and specialised roles, which slows down the hiring process and affects workforce readiness.

Selection at JKH is designed to build a workforce that reflects the Group's values and strategic priorities. The use of psychometric assessments and competency-based interviews ensures alignment with the Group's "Success Drivers" framework. Additionally, the Group leverages digital platforms to conduct online interviews, enabling a broader talent pool and improving accessibility for candidates across regions. This practice also reduces the need for candidate travel, contributing to lower carbon emissions and aligning with the Group's commitment to reducing its environmental impact. However, a challenge in selection is maintaining consistency and fairness across diverse business sectors with different operational needs, which can delay decisions and impact hiring efficiency.

Training and development are a cornerstone of JKH's HRM approach, providing employees with an average of 32 training hours annually. Programmes such as the Management Development Programme, SHINE for first-time managers, and LeadHERship for female leaders support skill-building and leadership development. Training is delivered through blended platforms like Bridge, which incorporates e-learning, virtual classrooms, and self-paced modules, making it accessible to employees across locations. Training and development empower employees with future-ready skills, strengthen diversity in leadership through targeted programmes like LeadHERship, and support the Group's alignment with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

Performance appraisal at John Keells Holdings PLC (JKH) is guided by its "Success Drivers" framework, aligning evaluations with company goals and leadership expectations. The Group follows a structured cycle with goal setting, mid-year check-ins, and year-end reviews, supported by continuous feedback. Compensation is performance-based, including competitive salaries, bonuses, and recognition for individual and team success. JKH promotes pay equity and offers benefits such as

medical coverage, wellness programmes, and flexible work arrangements. However, some employees feel appraisal outcomes can be affected by managerial discretion, leading to concerns about fairness. Additionally, junior staff sometimes feel excluded from performance-based rewards and growth opportunities compared to higher-level employees.

Learning Outcomes and Assessment Criteria

Learning Outcomes	Pass	Merit	Distinction
1. Understand the scope, functions and processes of Human Resource Management in improving organisational and employee performance	1.1 Explain the purpose, scope, functions and processes within HRM 1.2 Appraise key elements of HRM and the contribution it makes to organisational and individual performance	1M1 Discuss a range of HRM elements that contribute to the achievement of organisational objectives	1D1 Appraise an extensive range of HRM elements and processes, justifying how it supports sustainable organisational performance
2. Understand the effective Human Resource Management practices in a work-related context to improve sustainable performance	2.1 Assess the HRM practices in a work-related context, using specific examples to demonstrate improvements in organisational effectiveness.	2M1 Evaluate the overall impact and contribution of HRM practices to sustainable business performance	

~ End of Paper ~